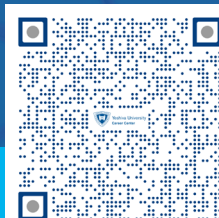


GUIDE TO MAJORS

ENGLISH



FOR ADDITIONAL
INFORMATION SCAN
THE CODE

WHAT IS ENGLISH?

The English major introduces students to a range of works in their historical, cultural and literary contexts and to practice reading and writing critically and imaginatively. As English majors, students are asked to consider how language shapes meaning and to imagine the lives and experiences of individuals from diverse cultures, time periods, and perspectives. Thus, students develop both analytically and creatively as writers and thinkers, learning to express themselves with clarity and power.

WHAT CAN I DO WITH THE MAJOR?

English graduates are equipped with a wide array of readily transferable skills. There is good reason why people trained to read and produce literature are in high demand for executive or high-ranking positions: the breadth of education, the quality of reasoning, the effectiveness of prose, and the flexibility of imagination will inevitably make one the better candidate for any position of interest.

English graduates are careful readers and thinkers and especially strong writers; they are well-prepared to excel in fields such as communications, new media, law, education, journalism, publishing, social work, business, medicine, nonprofit organizations and the arts. Skills developed in literature and writing courses yield advantages not only in the fields of teaching, publishing, and journalism but also in any profession in which critical thinking, analysis, and the ability to communicate effectively are vital.

TRACKS IN THE MAJOR

For more information within English visit:

■ yu.edu/academic-advising/undergraduate-men/sheets

■ yu.edu/advising/stern-academic-advising/sheets



Yeshiva University

SHEVET GLAUBACH CENTER FOR CAREER
STRATEGY AND PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

CAREER TRACKS

English is an ideal major for anyone interested in a career that demands strong communications skills, creativity, and critical acumen. English majors can enter careers in a range of industries. Some potential career titles include:

Academia/Education

- English as a Second Language Instructor, English Teacher—elementary and secondary schools' level
- English Professor (Ph.D. required), Writing Center Instructor, Writing or Language Coach/Tutor

Business/Industry

- Analyst, Claims Examiner
- Corporate Trainer
- Direct Mail Specialist
- Human Resources Executive

Communications/Broadcasting

- Account Executive, Advertising Copywriter, Media Planner
- Film Researcher, Film Reviewer
- Interpreter, Translator, Literary Agent
- Social Media Manager

Writing/Publishing

- Book Publishing Professional, Copy Editor, Magazine Editor
- Continuity/Grants Writer
- Journalist, Technical Writer, Financial Writer

Other Professions:
Graduate study required

- Curator for Special Collections
- Lawyer, Paralegal
- Librarian, Archivist
- Physician

GRADUATE AND PROFESSIONAL PROGRAMS

As English majors pursue careers in a wide range of fields, there is no one graduate program suggested. However, for those interested in teaching, a graduate degree is preferred and is suggested to obtain immediately after undergraduate school; for those in medicine or law a professional degree is required. Programs to consider are:

- Michigan State University—Master of Arts in Teaching and Curriculum
- Teachers College, Columbia University—Master of Arts in Teaching

Graduate school is an investment you will want to research thoroughly to better understand what you can expect to get out of your degree both academically and professionally.

SALARY EXPECTATIONS

The median annual wage for English majors varies widely. Here are just some median salaries based on industry:

- Lawyers: \$126,930
- Communications (Advertising, PR, Promotions, Marketing, Journalism, Publishing): \$41,950 - \$150,930
- PR: \$62,810
- Technical Writers: \$74,650
- Fundraisers: \$59,610
- Teaching: \$60,660 - \$80,560

For these and additional careers and salaries, visit U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics, U.S. Department of Labor, Occupational Outlook Handbook, www.bls.gov/ooh

SKILLS AND ABILITIES

- Active listening and learning
- Conducting interviews
- Critical thinking and analysis
- Meet deadlines
- Oral and written communication
- Pitch ideas
- Reading/Interpretation of texts
- Research
- Work independently and/or teamwork

CAREER RESOURCES

Online Resources

- Paul Corrigan, "English Majors Get Jobs"
- George Mason University's English Department's "English Career Resources"
- Judah Stiefel ('19YC English) "Consider the English Major" YU Commentator
- Vault
- **YU Clubs:** Campus Writing Center, The Commentator, Dramatics Society, Literary Journals, Poetry Club, Science Fiction Club,

NETWORKING ORGANIZATIONS

- American Association of Advertising Agencies
- American Bar Association (ABA)
- American Marketing Association
- American Medical Association (AMA)
- International Association of Business Communicators
- Modern Language Association
- National Association of Broadcasters
- Public Relations Society of America
- Society for Technical Communication
- Society of Professional Journalists